

The God of Sticks and Stones

Scripture, Creation, and the Quiet Language of God

Closing Reflection C — The God Who Is Near

You will set this book down, and the room will still be the room.

The same light. The same sounds from outside. The same ordinary weight of whatever the day holds next.

And God will be there.

Not waiting for a more spiritual version of you to arrive. Not requiring that you have understood everything. Simply present — the way he has always been present — within the ordinary hours, patient with the pace of ordinary lives.

He met people at wells when they were just trying to get water. He sat at tables with people who were surprised to be invited. He walked beside two people on a road and let them talk for hours before they recognized him.

He has always been patient with that kind of pace.

The room you return to is not a lesser place than the one this book has inhabited. The ordinary moment — the kitchen, the drive, the quiet morning before anyone else is awake — is not a distance from what this book has been pointing toward.

It is exactly where the pointing has been aimed.

You do not need to go looking for him.

He is already present — within whatever ordinary thing you carry into the next hour, and the one after that.

The invitation has not closed.